EPISTOLA Quam SSmus D. N. Leo PP. X I I I ad E.mum Card. F e r r a r i , Archiepiscopum Medio- lanensem, aliosque provinciae Praesules rescribens misit.

Leo XIII · 1903-06-03 · Latin

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LEO P P . XIII.

Dilecte Fili Noster, Salutem et Apostolicam Benedictionem.

C o m m u n e s litteras, q u a s R a u d i i n s o l e m n e m c o n g r e g a t i coetum tu ceterique Mediolanensis provinciae Praesules ad Nos dedistis, h a u d mediocri a n i m i oblectatione i a m p r i d e m legimus. L u c u l e n t a e n i m significatio ibi c o n t i n e b a t u r t u m v e h e m e n t i s studii, q u o v e s t r a r u m E c c l e s i a r u m b o n o v i g i l a n t e s p r o s p i c i t i s : t u m c o n s t a n t i s o b s e q u i i , q u o c u m R o m a n i Pontificis d o c u m e n t i s p l a n e sentitis. Q u o d a v o b i s n u n c i a t u m e s t i n e o v o s p r o vi- ribus a d l a b o r a r e ut christiana plebs, divinae sapientiae exculta praeceptis, melior in dies evadat, id sacerdotalis m u n e r i s m a - x i m a m excipit p a r t e m i d e m q u e Nobis valde p r o b a t u r : p o r r o q u u m m a g i s ovile l u p o r u m p a t e t i n c u r s i b u s , e o ^ a i o r i n d u s t r i a i n p r o h i b e n d i s p e r i c u l i s e s t a d h i b e n d a p a s t o r i . Q u u m v e r o cer- t u m c o m p e r t u m q u e sit p o p u l u m i n p a s t o r e s t a m q u a m i n e x e m - p l a r i n t u e r i e o r u m q u e m o r e s p l u s q u a m p r a e c e p t a v a l e r e , illud i n p r i m i s e a r u m c o m m e n d a r e libet, scilicet q u o d v o b i s s a n c t a et esse et futura profiteamini, q u a e superiori a n n o de s a c r o r u m a l u m n i s rite i n s t i t u e n d i s d e c r e v i m u s . Q u i p p e i n t a n t o bello c o n t r a c a t h o l i c u m m i n i s t e r i u m u n d i q u e inflato, c u r a r e u t cle- rici i n s a c r i s e p h e b e i s , a d o m n e m o p t i m a m a r t e m c o m p o s i t i , i n s p e m E c c l e s i a e veluti i n v i r i d a r i o s u c c r e s c a n t : e o s p e c t a r e u t s a c e r d o t e s a s e ipsis e x c u l t i s e t a l e s i m p e r t i a n t q u a l e m P a u l u s v o l u i t s e p r a e b e r e T i t u m « in omnibus teipsum praebe exemplum bonorum operum in doctrina, in integritate, in gravitate » (1); h a e c officia p r a e s t a n t i s s i m a E p i s c o p o r u m s u n t , q u a e effuso c o m p l e c t i m u r a n i m o q u i b u s q u e m a g n o p e r e d e l e c t a m u r . D e o i g i t u r confisi p e r g i t e i n c o e p t a : q u o d s i m u l s e r u i s t i s u b e - r e m ferat fructum, auspice Apostolica Benedictione, q u a m pa- t e r n a e b e n e v o l e n t i a e N o s t r a e t e s t e m Ubi dilecte f i l i , c e t e r i s v e - ti) Ad Titum c. II. 5.

nerabilibus fratribus gregique christiano uniuscuiusque curis commisso peramanter impertimus. D a t u m R o m a e a p u d S . P e t r u m , d i e III Iunii a n n o MCMIII, Pontificatus Nostri vigesimo sexto.

LEO P P . XIII.

Dilecto Filio Nostro Andreae Tit. S. Anastasiae S. R. E. Presb, Card. Ferrari Archiepiscopo Mediolanensi.

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